

Transforming Certification for Better Care

ABMS CONFERENCE 2026

Designing Tests for the Future of Certification: Structured Debates on AI, Outcomes, and Longitudinal Assessment

September 16, 2026

Sarah Schnabel, PhD, Andrew Jones, PhD, Mikaela Raddatz, PhD, Susan Davis-Becker, PhD

Sarah Schnabel, PhD

Independent Psychometric Consultant
Senior Psychometrician, ACS Ventures (10/2026)

Andrew Jones, PhD

Chief Operating and Assessment Officer, American Board of Surgery

Mikaela Raddatz, PhD

Director of Psychometrics and Research, American Board of Physical
Medicine and Rehabilitation

Susan Davis-Becker, PhD

Founding Partner, ACS Ventures, LLC

Disclosure

The presenters are employees at their respective organizations and have nothing else to disclose.

Debate Format

Moderator will present topic

Debater 1 (4 min)

Debater 2 (4 min)

Practical considerations (4 min)

Audience Questions/Comments on all three topics at the end.

Transforming Certification for Better Care

ABMS CONFERENCE 2026

TOPIC 1: Should “knowledge” assessment change in the age of AI?

Moderator: Sarah Schnabel

Debaters: Andrew Jones, Susan Davis-Becker

Practical Considerations: Mikaela Raddatz



Transforming Certification for Better Care

ABMS CONFERENCE 2026

TOPIC 2: Are patient outcomes defensible measures of individual physician competence?

Moderator: Susan Davis-Becker

Debaters: Mikaela Raddatz, Sarah Schnabel

Practical Considerations: Andrew Jones



Transforming Certification for Better Care

ABMS CONFERENCE 2026

TOPIC 3: What is the appropriate level of content customization in high-stakes certification and longitudinal assessment programs?

Moderator: Andrew Jones

Debaters: Sarah Schnabel, Mikaela Raddatz

Practical Considerations: Susan Davis-Becker



Transforming Certification for Better Care

ABMS CONFERENCE 2026

Poll Results, Audience Q&A

Mikaela Raddatz, PhD

Poll Results

Questions?

Thank you!

Susan Davis-Becker, PhD

sdavisbecker@acsventures.com

Andrew Jones, PhD

ajones@absurgery.org

Mikaela Raddatz, PhD

MRaddatz@abpmmr.org

Sarah Schnabel, PhD

sschnabel@acsventures.com